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Gautam Gambhir (top) and Virender Sehwag



AP Photo

openers in particular.

Virender Sehwag churns out numbers flitting between genius and greed, but he is not about those figures. As much and as quickly he gulps them down, his batting is about an expansiveness of spirit.

Once again, Sehwag set up big games and became a breathing, moving, swinging example of why Test cricket should always be fought for. Seeing a batsman like him only for 20 overs is not entertainment, it is merely a morsel of cheer.

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It is not the quality that is spoken of the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) and its latest off-spring, the Organising

Committee of the 2010 Commonwealth Games in New Delhi. The city will be ready in time, of course, but not without another round of what happened in 2009: outbursts and power-tussles between IOA President Suresh Kalmadi and Commonwealth Games Federation CEO Mike Hooper. But neither of these gentlemen keep Indian sport going.

It is the Guevaras who do, flinging themselves into contest. What Indian sport needs from now on is another avatar of revolutionaries, this time in suits. Of the kind willing to put in resources to supporting these coura-

ALL EYES ON...

Davis Cup: India vs Russia, March 5-7

India's first shot at the Tennis World Group in 11 years. In Russia, where the vodka may be warm, but the competition is steely.

FIFA World Cup, South Africa, June 11-July 10

So what if India hasn't qualified and North Korea has. The world's biggest sport and its prime event goes to Africa for the first time.

Commonwealth Games, Delhi, October 3-14

Delhi has to prove that it can move past red tape and get its act together to spruce up infrastructure and stage a world-class meet

Asian Games, Guangzhou, Nov 12-27

To discover India's most enduring athletes in two multi-discipline events within five weeks may require divine intervention

Cricket: India vs South Africa

Two Test series in two continents that bookend 2010 will establish without doubt as to which of them is the real No. 1

geous soloists. It is being explored by a few, private bodies funded by business and enthusiasts who know the science of sports and marketing.

But still Devvarman and Bhambri, Bhullar and Lahiri, Sai Dutt and Suranjoy and Nanao and many more will need to find shoulders that will push wheels across important inches.

Because after all, India is a land of many. Many dreams, many demands, many ambitions. Indian sport too needs many more of its large-hearted. ■